National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Alexandria, MN	**Accident Number:**	CHI08CA057
Date & Time:	12/30/2007, 1515 CST	**Registration:**	N5093F
Aircraft:	Lerohl RV-8	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot reported that he conducted a preflight and run-up of the amateur-built experimental airplane, and he reported that it was operating normally. The airplane had climbed to 200 - 300 feet at 90 knots when the engine lost power. The pilot executed a forced landing to the airport property. The airplane landed hard and the main landing gear collapsed. The airplane and engine were inspected but the reason for the loss of power was not determined.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The loss of engine power for undetermined reasons.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF ENGINE POWER
Phase of Operation: TAKEOFF - INITIAL CLIMB

Findings
1. (C) REASON FOR OCCURRENCE UNDETERMINED

Occurrence #2: FORCED LANDING
Phase of Operation: EMERGENCY DESCENT/LANDING

Occurrence #3: HARD LANDING
Phase of Operation: EMERGENCY DESCENT/LANDING

Findings
2. TERRAIN CONDITION - GROUND

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Commercial	**Age:**	62, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Multi-engine Land; Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	04/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	2364 hours (Total, all aircraft), 82 hours (Total, this make and model), 12 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Lerohl	**Registration:**	N5093F
Model/Series:	RV-8	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	Yes
Airworthiness Certificate:	Experimental	**Serial Number:**	80900
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	10/01/2007, Condition	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	82 Hours at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Mazda
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	13B
Registered Owner:	Gaylen Lerohl	**Rated Power:**	150 hp
Operator:	Gaylen Lerohl	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:		**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:		**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:		**Visibility**	
Lowest Ceiling:		**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	/	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:		**Temperature/Dew Point:**	
Precipitation and Obscuration:			
Departure Point:	Alexandria, MN (AXN)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:		**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	1515 CST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Chandler Field Airport (AXN)	**Runway Surface Type:**	
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	
Runway Used:	13	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:		**VFR Approach/Landing:**	

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	45.866111, -95.394444

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Jim Silliman	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:			
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.